ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 27: **The Tale of Custard the Dragon (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** Ogden Nash	An American humorist.
2	**(d)** a nice safe cage	He was timid.
3	**(b)** contrast between the dragon's looks and his nature	Fierce looks, timid nature.
4	**(a)** humorous ballad	Narrative comic verse.
5	**(c)** a coward	He cried for a cage.
6	**(b)** true courage may come from the least expected	Moral.
7	**(c)** little white house	A small house.
8	**(b)** pirate	A pirate with weapons.
9	**(b)** short sword	A sword.
10	**(b)** Ink	Black kitten.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Belinda lived with a kitten, a mouse, a dog (1) and a pet dragon named Custard (1).	1+1
12	Everyone ran away and hid (1) except Custard who stayed put (1).	1+1
13	Custard remains timid (1) and keeps asking for his cage (1).	1+1
14	Ink the kitten and Blink the mouse (1) Mustard the dog and Custard the dragon (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He had big sharp teeth (1). He had spikes and scales (1). Despite his looks, he was timid (1).	1+1+1
16	The 'coward' saves everyone (1). The 'brave' run away (1). Custard still wants his cage (1).	1+1+1
17	'Realio, trulio' (1). Names such as Ink, Blink, Mustard, Custard (1). They add fun (1).	1+1+1
	OR: A little white house (1). A kitten, mouse and dog (1). And a pet dragon (1).	1+1+1
18	Couplets (1). Bouncing rhythm (1). Made-up words for fun (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Belinda cried out for help (1). Exclamation turned into reporting (1). Tense preserved (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Belinda and her pets (1). Custard's fears (1). Pirate arrives (1). Custard saves them (1). He remains timid (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Date (1). The day (1). The pirate (1). Custard's deed (1). Thoughts (1).	2+2+1
20	Fierce in looks (1). Timid by nature (1). Teased by others (1). Brave in action (1). Humble at heart (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Thanks (1). Custard's modesty (1). The cage (1). End (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling the poem a tragedy; it is a **humorous ballad** by Ogden Nash that tells a story with strong rhythm and rhyme.
- Mixing the pets: Belinda's pets are **Ink** (kitten), **Blink** (mouse), **Mustard** (dog) and **Custard** (dragon).
- Saying Custard was brave in the beginning; he is the **cowardly dragon** who cries for a safe cage, but he gobbles up the pirate.
- Missing the irony: the only 'cowardly' pet is the one who **defeats the pirate**, while the others only boast about courage.
- Ignoring the devices: *simile* ('clashed his tail like iron in a dungeon'), exaggeration and comic rhymes ('realio, trulio').
- Spelling slips: *Belinda, Custard, dragon, pirate, ballad, Ogden Nash*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

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Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 27: **The Tale of Custard the Dragon (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** ran away and hid	They fled.
2	**(a)** one who lacks courage	Fearful.
3	**(c)** Blink	Grey mouse.
4	**(a)** Custard	The dragon.
5	**(c)** The pirate was eaten by Custard.	Past passive.
6	**(b)** Mustard	Yellow dog.
7	**(b)** gobbling him up	He swallowed him.
8	**(c)** cowardly	Brave x cowardly.
9	**(a)** Custard	Title character.
10	**(a)** afraid and wanting a cage	Remained timid.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He gobbled him up (1) saving the household (1).	1+1
12	True courage may be found in unexpected places (1) and boasts are empty (1).	1+1
13	Belinda is brave as a barrel of bears (1) and the others are boasted as brave in funny comparisons (1).	1+1
14	They came back and praised him (1) but he still cried for a safe cage (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Comparisons with bears and tigers (1). Chasing lions down stairs (1). Their actions contradict their claims (1).	1+1+1
16	Fierce looks may hide fear (1). Brave talk may hide cowardice (1). Judge by deeds (1).	1+1+1
17	The timid dragon hid (1). Nobody called him a coward later (1). Both words used correctly (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He came with weapons (1). He entered the house (1). Everyone was frightened (1).	1+1+1
18	Barrel of bears (1). Lions down stairs (1). Pirate's arsenal (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Courage is in action (1). Do not boast (1). Fear can coexist with bravery (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Fearsome looks (1). Boastful pets (1). Pirate scene (1). Custard's triumph (1). Final irony (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Headline (1). Intro (1). Details (1). Quotes (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
20	Theme (1). Humour (1). Rhyme and rhythm (1). Characters (1). Opinion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Title (1). Rhyme (1). Story (1). Humour (1). Ending (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling the poem a tragedy; it is a **humorous ballad** by Ogden Nash that tells a story with strong rhythm and rhyme.
- Mixing the pets: Belinda's pets are **Ink** (kitten), **Blink** (mouse), **Mustard** (dog) and **Custard** (dragon).
- Saying Custard was brave in the beginning; he is the **cowardly dragon** who cries for a safe cage, but he gobbles up the pirate.
- Missing the irony: the only 'cowardly' pet is the one who **defeats the pirate**, while the others only boast about courage.
- Ignoring the devices: *simile* ('clashed his tail like iron in a dungeon'), exaggeration and comic rhymes ('realio, trulio').
- Spelling slips: *Belinda, Custard, dragon, pirate, ballad, Ogden Nash*.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 27: **The Tale of Custard the Dragon (First Flight Poem)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** shy and fearful	Fearful.
2	**(b)** a barrel full of bears	A comic comparison.
3	**(a)** humorous	Light.
4	**(c)** through	Came in through.
5	**(b)** lions down the stairs	Comic exaggeration.
6	**(d)** rhymed couplets	Rhyming pairs.
7	**(b)** sharp teeth and spikes	Fierce looks.
8	**(b)** a tiger in a rage	A funny comparison.
9	**(c)** ironic	Custard remains a coward though he is the brave one.
10	**(c)** bouncy	Sing-song.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Ogden Nash (1) an American humorous poet (1).	1+1
12	He was always asking for a safe cage (1) and was thus called a coward (1).	1+1
13	A fierce-looking dragon is a coward (1) while the 'brave' ones run (1).	1+1
14	Rhymed couplets (1) in a bouncy rhythm (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	They ran away (1). They hid (1). They abandoned Belinda (1).	1+1+1
16	It repeats the comparisons (1). It shows Custard unchanged (1). It ends on humour (1).	1+1+1
17	Funny characters (1). Rhyme (1). A twist ending (1).	1+1+1
	OR: He stayed (1). He acted swiftly (1). He swallowed the pirate (1).	1+1+1
18	Bravery shows in action (1). Don't judge by talk (1). Be modest (1).	1+1+1
	OR: A little yellow dog (1). Claimed to be brave (1). Ran away from the pirate (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Custard's looks vs others (1). Claims vs deeds (1). Pirate scene (1). Outcome (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Courage in action (1). Not in words (1). Custard's example (1). Humility (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Address (1). Greeting (1). Story (1). Fun (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Pirate enters (1). Pets flee (1). Belinda cries (1). Custard acts (1). Outcome (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling the poem a tragedy; it is a **humorous ballad** by Ogden Nash that tells a story with strong rhythm and rhyme.
- Mixing the pets: Belinda's pets are **Ink** (kitten), **Blink** (mouse), **Mustard** (dog) and **Custard** (dragon).
- Saying Custard was brave in the beginning; he is the **cowardly dragon** who cries for a safe cage, but he gobbles up the pirate.
- Missing the irony: the only 'cowardly' pet is the one who **defeats the pirate**, while the others only boast about courage.
- Ignoring the devices: *simile* ('clashed his tail like iron in a dungeon'), exaggeration and comic rhymes ('realio, trulio').
- Spelling slips: *Belinda, Custard, dragon, pirate, ballad, Ogden Nash*.

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